

ISABELLA IPPOLITO

SENIOR PIPELINE TECHNICAL DIRECTOR

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SKILLS

Programming

Python, VEX, PySide2, C++, GitHub, REST APIs

Systems & Pipeline

Tools Development for artists, USD, PDG, ShotGrid (Flow), Asset managers and publishers, Farm schedulers, Unit Testing, Bug Tracking, Code Review

DCCs

Houdini, Maya, Nuke, 3DEqualizer, Deadline

AI / ML

ONNX, ML Train Regression, LLM tools, PyTorch

Soft Skills

- Collaboration & Cross-Functional Teamwork
- Leadership & Mentoring
- Agile Methodology (JIRA)
- MoSCoW Planning
- Proactive Problem-Solving
- Ownership & Initiative
- Analytical Thinking

EDUCATION

BSc Creative Digital Media

First Class Honours
University of Greenwich,
London 2015 – 2018

Digital Media Design, Computing and Programming, Games Design and Development, Visual Storytelling, 3D Animation, Installation Development, Advanced 3D Animation, User Interface Design, and Interaction Design. Final Year Project: Advection of Fluids Simulations using Houdini (View [PDF](#)).

AWARDS

Netflix Animation Hackathon 2024

People's Choice — LLM Smart Search Engine.

Animal Logic Hackathon 2022

Judge's Choice — AI Art Generation with production assets.

University of Greenwich 2018

Outstanding Achievement, Digital Media.

CERTIFICATES

- AI Foundations Machine Learning, LinkedIn Learning, 2022
- Animated Women UK Helen North Achieve Programme, 2021
- Next Gen Futures VFX Bootcamp, Mayor of London
- Italian State Diploma Chemistry & Biology, 100/100
- ECDL European Computer Driving Licence
- IELTS, Kaplan English School, New York
- ESOL Trinity College, Levels 4, 5 and 7
- DELF, Diplôme d'études en langue française

VOLUNTEERING

- Mentor, University of Greenwich (2025–Present)
- Mentor, Animated Women UK (2022–Present)
- SIGGRAPH Asia Women in Tech BoF speaker (2023)
- Mentor, UTS Women in Engineering (2024)
- Volunteer usher, Greenwich Theatre

ABOUT ME

Pipeline Developer passionate about designing innovative tools and solving complex technical challenges to improve production pipelines. Experienced in building pipeline tools across VFX and animation, specialising in Houdini , USD/Solaris, PDG and ML-integrated workflows, always seeking opportunities to expand my skills and explore new technologies.

WORK EXPERIENCE

PIPELINE TECHNICAL DIRECTOR — PIXOMONDO

London, 2025 – Present

- Supporting TV and film productions across Maya, Houdini, Nuke and USD pipeline
- Resolving technical issues with artists and department leads, code review and studio standards
- Maintaining show-based tools and delivering pipeline features as production evolves

SENIOR HOUDINI DEVELOPER — HOGARTH WPP MEDIA

London, 2025

- Built procedural Houdini tools and pipeline workflows for high-volume advertising productions
- USD/Solaris lighting workflow optimisation, Deadline + PDG/TOPs render automation

PROCEDURAL ASSETS & FX TECHNICAL DIRECTOR — NETFLIX ANIMATION / ANIMAL LOGIC

Sydney, 2023 – 2025

Building and supporting tools in SideFX Houdini:

- Developed and supported tools for fx, crowds, modelling and surfacing in advanced USD/ Solaris pipeline.
- Implemented a custom PDG scheduler to submit and manage jobs on the studio farm, handling work items, dependencies, batching, scheduler callbacks, and farm-side support for PDG logic.
- Developed a Houdini 20 workflow using PDG and ONNX to wrap muscle and bone logic into a custom environment and HDA that outputs linear blend skinning for character workflows.
- Texture Library HDA using COPS/ROPS/TOPS/VEX; contact sheet generator ROP HDA for review workflows.
- Python unit tests for FX workflows; turntables, resolvers, groom and knitting tool support.

PERFORMANCE TECHNICAL DIRECTOR — NETFLIX / ANIMAL LOGIC

Sydney, 2022 – 2023

- USD asset resolver changes for layout, assets and shot entity creation workflows
- Automated character pose loading in Maya; supported shot build and review tooling
- Large-scale production support through tooling, debugging and pipeline improvements

PIPELINE TECHNICAL DIRECTOR — UNION VFX

London, 2021 – 2022

- Built ShotGrid publishing systems, custom Nuke nodes and USD + PDG pipeline transitions
- On set ingest tool with PySide and Deadline; Deadline event automations
- Contributed to ShotGrid Config transition and Houdini pipeline tooling

RENDER WRANGLER TECHNICAL DIRECTOR — UNION VFX

London, 2019 – 2022

- Managed and optimised render farm (Deadline); automated repetitive workflows with Python
- Trained and led part-time wrangler team; collaborated with pipeline engineering

VIDEO EDITOR & MOTION DESIGNER — FREELANCE

London, 2015 – 2019

- The People’s Picture including projects for NASA at the Kennedy Space Center Florida, Penguin Books, EY, Jose Cuervo, and Piccadilly Lights.

- Start Me Up Careers based in Bali